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The Insider

TRUE TALES ABOUT PEOPLE IN THE NEWS

Double jeopardy

You think you have personnel problems? "Grace Under Fire" executive producer **Marc Flanagan** tells TV Guide how it was working with **Brett Butler,** whose increasingly erratic behavior on the set finally brought production to a close.

"One minute she would be happy, and the next she'd read an item about herself in the newspaper and it would be impossible to get her out of her trailer. Every day I would come to work and my hands would start to shake."

What's more, he said, "she had new breasts, so she would lift her blouse and flash people. 'Say hello to the boys,' she would say in some kind of weird metaphor."



Brett Butler: Greetings!

Revolving-door policy

L.A. County Sheriff **Sherman Block** insists he's not going to tolerate any more get-out-of-jail-free passes for **Robert Downey Jr.,** who was locked up to learn his lesson but has twice been allowed out to do some voice-over movie work.

"It's too disruptive and not the way to operate a jail, for the convenience of any inmate, no matter who that might be," Block said. We can hear the studio chiefs rumbling now: "He'll never work in this town again."

Exclusive!

Internet celebrity snoop **Matt Drudge,** deciding to capitalize on his 15 minutes of fame, has signed with the Fox News Channel to host a weekly TV panel show starting in late May.

Chet Collier, a senior vice president of Fox News, said the network will try to make sure what Drudge puts on the air is factual. Well, phooey, that's no fun.

Coffee, tea or thorazine?

Aussie flight attendants will refuse to work on planes carrying **Oasis** unless the British rock band guarantees it will behave, union secretary John Walker has announced. And if the attendants don't work, the planes don't fly. The band and its rowdy entourage — about 30 people in all — flew low-class from Hong Kong to Australia last week and disrupted the flight.

FYI

■ Romance writer **Danielle Steel,** 49, who has written 70 books, given birth to seven children and the heave-ho to four husbands, plans to marry venture capitalist **Thomas J. Perkins,** 65, a widower. She did not announce the date.

■ Epic Records has paid in excess of $3 million for the soundtrack rights to "Ally McBeal," TV's latest darling. The album will be a boost for **Vonda Shepard,** who performs in every episode and sings the theme song, "Searchin' My Soul."

Birthdays:

Actress **Jennifer Jones,** 79.
Bluegrass singer-musician **Doc Watson,** 75.
Actor **John Cullum,** 68.
Former Soviet President **Mikhail S. Gorbachev,** 67.
Author **Tom Wolfe,** 67.
Author **John Irving,** 56.
Singer **Lou Reed,** 56.
Singer **Eddie Money,** 49.
Actress **Laraine Newman,** 48.
Pop musician **John Cowsill (The Cowsills),** 42.
Rock singer **Jon Bon Jovi,** 36.

— *Richard Des Ruisseaux, The Courier-Journal*

"The Insider" appears Monday through Friday. You can reach Richard Des Ruisseaux at (502) 582-4797 or e-mail him at: desrui@iglou.com

Bright Ideas

TIPS FOR LIVING LIFE BETTER

PERSONAL

Circling wrists for a cause



Tim Allen, Hillary Clinton, Bette Midler, Rosie O'Donnell, Robert Redford, Maria Shriver, Sinbad, Oprah Winfrey and Magic Johnson either wear or support the sale of bracelets made by Until There's a Cure Foundation, a non-profit organization in San Mateo, Calif.

So far, more than $2.35 million raised from the sale of the bracelets has been **donated to HIV/AIDS-related causes.**

Gold and silver bracelets — reminiscent of those worn in the 1970s to remember prisoners of war and soldiers missing in action during the Vietnam War — are being worn to raise awareness and educate teen-agers about HIV/AIDS and to support research for an AIDS vaccine. Each bracelet **bears the slogan "Until There's a Cure."** They also are worn in memory of those who died from the disease and for those who continue the battle against it.

"The Bracelet" costs $20 (silver-plate), $70 (sterling) and $350 (14k gold).

HEALTH

How to stick with exercise

Have you given up on your New Year's resolution to exercise? Try these tips from a recent issue of Shape magazine:

■ Don't expect to lose more than one pound a week. It may take **two to three months to notice** significant changes in your body.

■ Don't overdo it — this can lead to injury. Don't push yourself — especially if you're a beginner. Develop a fitness base that you can build upon later.

■ Choose a specific objective each week or each month. Aim to take a class twice a week or walk to work. Achieving such **tangible goals** will give you a feeling of accomplishment.

■ Keep an exercise log. It's a great way to track your progress. Even small achievements, like adding 5 pounds to the chest-press machine, are notable.

■ Don't focus on numbers. Pay attention to how good exercise makes you feel.

— *Gannett News Service*

For a retail store near you or to order by phone, call (800) 888-6845.

— *Ken Neuhauser, The Courier-Journal*

TECHNOLOGY

African-American info abounds on the Net

As the Internet grows, it increasingly is fostering networks of like-minded people, whether for practical ends like commerce or for broader goals like building political communities. An array of Web sites attempts to help African Americans on both levels — **from employment opportunities to culture and literature.**

■ One place to start is Everythingblack (www.everythingblack.com), a sort of mega-mall home page. It displays 12 broad categories — from arts and humanities to business, entertainment and travel — that offer links to hundreds of Web sites, including African-American community news outlets all over the country.

■ There are numerous specialized sites too. Mosaicbooks.com/The Black Literary Showcase (www.mosaicbooks.com), an affiliate of online bookstore Amazon.com, features summaries and recommendations on current **black and Hispanic literature.**

■ Black Facts Online (www.blackfacts.com) is a fledgling database/search engine that aspires to be "Your Internet Resource of Black History Information."

■ Black Urban Professionals Online (www.*bupple*.com) provides parenting tips, a résumé databank, guidance on personal finance, and professional and social calendars.

■ The Black Collegian Online (www.black-collegian.com) offers career advice and a **state-by-state job database.** And that's just a smattering.

■ For children, Shelton Jewette, owner of Computers 101, a Washington computer training center, recommends the AFRO-America® Kids Zone (www.*afroam.org/children.children.html*) — which includes fables, games, puzzles and brain teasers.

— *Gannett News Service*

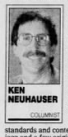


Write to **Bright Ideas, The Courier-Journal,** 525 W. Broadway, P.O. Box 740031, Louisville, Ky. 40201-7431. Or send a fax to (502) 582-4665. Or e-mail us at: cjbright@louisv02.gannett.com

What's Up Today

The best bet: All that jazz

If it's the first Monday in March, it's time for the **Louisville Jazz Society's** regularly scheduled "First Monday Series." And that's what's in store tonight when the **Jerry Tolson Quintet** will perform at 7:30 at the Comedy Caravan Mid-City Mall, 1250 Bardstown Road.



KEN NEUHAUSER COLUMN

This dynamic Louisville-area ensemble will perform standards and contemporary jazz and a few original compositions by members of the ensemble. It covers the musical gamut from Kirk Whalum and Grover Washington to Charlie Parker and Dizzy Gillespie.

Tolson, who is a jazz studies professor at the University of Louisville School of Music, is the group leader and is featured on piano and vocals.

Other members are Jeff Sherman on guitar, Ed Humphries on saxophone, Dwight Dozier on drums and Sonny Stephens on bass.

Admission is $5 ($3 for jazz society members).

"Bright Ideas" runs Monday through Friday in Features. You can reach Ken Neuhauser at (502) 582-4204.

'Tosca' talk

Kentucky Opera's production of Giacomo Puccini's tragic opera **"Tosca"** opens at 8 p.m. Friday in Whitney Hall at the Kentucky Center for the Arts with a second and final performance at 2 p.m. Sunday.

The arts center is at Sixth and Main streets. For ticket information and reservations, call (502) 584-7777 or (800) 775-7777.

You can learn more about Kentucky Opera and its new general director, Deborah Sandler, during tomorrow's **Lunch & Listen** program, sponsored by the Kentucky Opera Guild.

Kirby Adams, co-host of WHAS-TV's "Louisville Tonight Live," will interview Sandler, who will talk about her background in the opera field and her views on the art form.

The Lunch & Listen program will begin at 12:10 p.m. at Vincenzo's Italian Restaurant, Fifth and Market streets.

The cost is $6 and includes lunch. Telephone reservations, which must be made by credit card, are due by noon today. Call (502) 584-4500.

Live events

Art

Louisville Free Public Library, Bernheim Gallery, 301 York St. Monday-Thursday, 9 a.m.-9 p.m.; Friday and Saturday, 9 a.m.-5 p.m.; Sunday, 1-5 p.m. Opening today, the Kentucky Watercolor Society All-Member Show; ends March 31. (502) 574-1611.

Louisville Free Public Library, Crescent Hill branch, 2762 Frankfort Ave. Monday, Tuesday and Thursday, 10 a.m.-9 p.m.; Wednesday, Friday and Saturday, 10 a.m.-5 p.m. Opening today, "Who Am I?" human and animal portraits in acrylic and tin sculpture by Krista Drybrough; ends March 31. (502) 574-1793.

Louisville Free Public Library, Middletown branch, 200 N. Juneau Drive. Monday-Saturday, 10 a.m.-8 p.m. Opening today, works by Eastern High School art students; ends March 31. (502) 245-7332.

Special films

IMAX Theatre. Louisville Science Center, 727 W. Main St. "The Magic of Flight" (45 min.): today, 1, 3, and 5 p.m. Alaska: Spirit of the Wild" (45 min.): today, 2 and 4 p.m. $7. $5.50 senior citizens and ages 2-12 (Science Center members: $4. $3.50 senior citizens and children). (502) 561-6100.

Falls of the Ohio Interpretive Center, 201 W. Riverside Drive, Clarksville. Film covering 400 million years at the falls (13 min.). Every 30 minutes, 9:30 a.m.-4:30 p.m. Building admission: $2. $1 ages 2-12, free for younger children. (812) 280-9970.

"The Greatest Race." A multimedia production. Today, hourly, 9:30 a.m.-4:30 p.m., Kentucky Derby Museum, Gate 1, Churchill Downs, 704 Central Ave. $6, $5 for ages 55 or older, $2 for ages 5-12. (502) 637-1111.

Standing attractions

This a rotating list of some of the popular attractions in our area.

Museums

Louisville Slugger Museum, Hillerich & Bradsby Co., 800 W. Main St. Today, 9 a.m.-5 p.m. $5; $4.50 senior citizens; $3 children ages 6-12; free for younger children. (502) 580-5226.

Museum of American Printing House for the Blind, 1839 Frankfort Ave. Today, 8:30 a.m.-4:30 p.m.; displays and artifacts relating to the education of blind people and Braille. Tours of the printing house, 10 a.m. and 2 p.m. Free admission and tours. (502) 895-2405.

Activities

Iceland, 1701 UPS Drive. Today, 2-5:30 p.m., 6:45-9 p.m. Admission: $4.50, $2 for ages 4 and 5, free for ages 3 and younger. Skate rental: $2, $1 for ages 5 and younger. (502) 327-6613.

Golf USA, Holiday Manor. Indoor golf and lessons. Today, 10 a.m.-8 p.m. Admission: nine holes, $10; 18 holes, $15. (502) 327-0410.

Laser Blaze Laser Tag, 4121 Shelbyville Road. Today, 4-10 p.m. Admission: $6. Daily special, Monday-Thursday, 4-7 p.m. $2 off. (502) 895-2985.

Cruises

Star of Louisville. Fourth Street and River Road. Dinner cruises: Today, 7-10 p.m., $32-$47. Lunch cruises: today, noon-2 p.m., $23.25. Hot and cold buffets and entertainment. Call (502) 589-7827.

Information for this calendar must be received by 10 a.m. on the business day before publication. Address: The Courier-Journal, 525 W. Broadway, P.O. Box 740031, Louisville, Ky. 40201-7431. Fax: (502) 582-4665.

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